FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of July 26 – August 1, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation

In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — Ephesians 4:29

"Let no corrupting talk come out of your mouths, but only such as is good for building up, as fits the occasion, that it may give grace to those who hear."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: 1 Samuel 10:1–27; Acts 22:17–29
Mon: 1 Samuel 12:1–25; Acts 22:30–23:11
Tue: 1 Samuel 13:1–18; Acts 23:12–35
Wed: 1 Samuel 14:47–15:9; Acts 24:1–23
Thu: 1 Samuel 15:10–35; Acts 24:24–25:12
Fri: 1 Samuel 16:1–23; Acts 25:13–27
Sat: 1 Samuel 17:1–19; Acts 26:1–23

Talk About It This Week

Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)

✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Jesus, Priceless Treasure" — LSB 743

Jesus, priceless treasure, / Fount of purest pleasure, / Truest friend to me. / Ah, how long in anguish / Shall my spirit languish, / Yearning, Lord, for Thee? / Thou art mine, O Lamb divine! / I will suffer naught to hide Thee; / Naught I ask beside Thee.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction

Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Ninth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 12) July 26, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 105:2–6; antiphon: v. 1*

Oh give thanks to the LORD; call upon his name;
make known his deeds among the peoples!
Sing to him, sing praises to him;
tell of all his wondrous works!
Glory in his holy name;
let the hearts of those who seek the LORD rejoice!
Seek the LORD and his strength;
seek his presence continually!
Remember the wondrous works that he has done,
his miracles, and the judgments he uttered,
O offspring of Abraham, his servant,
children of Jacob, his chosen ones!
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
Oh give thanks to the LORD; call upon his name;
make known his deeds among the peoples!

Collect of the Day

Almighty and everlasting God, give us an increase of faith, hope, and love, that, receiving what You have promised, we may love what You have commanded; through Jesus Christ, Your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Deuteronomy 7:6–9 · Psalm 125 · Romans 8:28–39 · Matthew 13:44–52

Gradual *Romans 11:33, 36*

Oh, the depth of the riches and wisdom and knowledge of God!
How unsearchable are his judgments and how inscrutable his ways!
For from him and through him and to him are all things.
To him be glory forever. Amen.

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 13)

Isaiah 55:1–5 · Psalm 136:1–9 (23–26) · Romans 9:1–5 (6–13) · Matthew 14:13–21

Learn by Heart: The Second Article of the Creed *LSB p. 322*

"…who has redeemed me, a lost and condemned person, purchased and won me from all sins, from death, and from the power of the devil… that I may be His own and live under Him in His kingdom…"

THIS WEEK AT HOME: In this Sunday's Gospel, a man finds treasure hidden in a field and, in his joy, sells everything to have it. The parable is first about Jesus: He gave everything — His own life — to make you His treasure. Deuteronomy 7 says God chose His people not because they were many or mighty, "but because the LORD loves you." Through the week, watch God choose and use unlikely people: Saul the donkey-seeker, David the youngest brother, Paul the prisoner. Ask one another: "If we are God's treasure, what does that make everything else we own?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is the "Gradual"?

The Gradual is the responsive reading between the Old Testament Reading and the Epistle. The word comes from the Latin gradus, meaning "step" — the Gradual is a stepping stone from one reading of God's Word to the next.

After we hear God's Word in the Old Testament, we use God's Word in the Gradual to step to God's Word in the Epistle. There sure is a lot of God's wonderful Word in the Divine Service!

Parents: *Before or after the Divine Service, show your children the Gradual for the day and remind them to concentrate on God's Word throughout the service.*

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